

Kristen de Guzman

6+ Years of Community-Led Growth & Partnerships | GTM Builder | 0-to-1 Operator | Serial Startup Leader

hi@kristendeguzman.com | (702) 443-1769 | Los Angeles, CA

SUMMARY

Three-time first sales hire with an entire career rooted in experimentation, execution, and building 0-1. Relationship-first leader who is scrappy, self-directed, and highly-autonomous. Demonstrated success in launching community-driven and partnership-led growth motions from zero. At a nonprofit, grew from inaugural BD hire to Board Member — architecting the organization's external relationships and referral engine from scratch. Entered CPG as the first-ever Head of Partnerships, standing up channel infrastructure that generated 1,900% revenue growth in 90 days. Most recently, the founding GTM lead at an AI startup, owning full client experience, pipeline design, and cross-functional voice of the customer. Expert at turning trust into repeatable, scalable revenue through a wide portfolio of channels, segments, and motions: ambassadors, strategic partners, community channels, and grassroots activations.

EXPERIENCE

Head of Client Experience (Founding GTM Hire)

February 2026 – Present

Helm | AI-Native SaaS

- Served as founding GTM hire at an AI-native startup, owning the full strategy development for niche ICP and sales motion for a new platform across B2B and B2C segments
- Achieved a 35% close rate after implementing early-stage GTM strategy with goal to evaluate product-market-fit and the optimal approaches to lead generation, outreach strategy, and pipeline
- Designed two custom AI infrastructures (*Claude*) to systematize sales messaging, qualification, and pipeline, enabling rapid experimentation and data-informed prioritization across the GTM motion
- Established daily communication cadences with clients and partners to translate actionable feedback to product and engineering teams

Head of Partnerships

January 2025 – June 2025

Buoy Hydration | DTC CPG Brand

- Delivered 1,900% growth in referral program revenue in 90 days by creating an affiliate structure from scratch — identifying a greenfield partner segment, designing the program architecture including necessary apps and platforms, and developing a playbook to be adopted in other verticals
- Shipped hands-on strategy with customized messaging to self-hunted pipeline to convert leads into 100+ revenue-driving partners from qualification through contract signature
- Drove community-integrated growth by partnering with creators, influencers, and wellness communities to leverage word-of-mouth equity and design foundation for a user-focused testimonial webpage

Business Development Manager

May 2020 – January 2025

Legacy Youth Leadership | 501(c)3 Non-profit

- Grew from inaugural BD hire to Board Member, building the organization's first external relationship infrastructure
- Achieved 90% retention rate across portfolio over 5 years by maintaining consistent, trust-based communication with stakeholders at individual, SMB, and enterprise levels across 5+ industries
- Yielded \$100,000+ yearly in referrals alone by building strategic word-of-mouth equity through a community-led acquisition loop
- Founded and chaired Legacy Ball, a high-profile community fundraising event generating over \$500,000 in 3 years — managing complex, multi-stakeholder relationships with media, agencies, sponsors, and community leaders

SKILLS & QUALIFICATIONS

GTM & Growth: Community-led and partnership-led growth, 0-to-1 channel development, affiliate/ambassador program creation, referral program design, grassroots activation, BD, full-cycle sales

Cross-functional: Product-sales bridge, voice of customer, scrum participation, member insights synthesis

Tooling & AI: Claude, ChatGPT, Google Workspace, Slack, Notion, Outline, Linear, Microsoft

Communication: Executive and community-level written, verbal, phone, and video communication

EDUCATION

B.S. in Business Administration, Management | University of Nevada, Reno | 3.8 GPA, Cum Laude